



## 'We are a nation OF TALKERS'

*It's the city of IT and pub protests; of education as well as innovation. Five young Indians from Bangalore debate whether the youth of the world's youngest nation are patriotic and involved in decision-making, or are decadent and resistant to change. Santosh Lad, 33, industrialist and Congress MLA from Kalghatgi; Arundhati Ghosh, 36, deputy director of the India Foundation for the Arts; Carlton Braganza, 36, musician and entrepreneur; Keshav Baljee, 25, co-promoter, Royal Orchid Hotels; and Vasanth Kumar Bhavani, 32, Shri Ram Sene's Bangalore president talk about their dreams and frustrations. Excerpts:*

**Keshav Baljee (KB):** Enough has been talked about young India. Let's talk about India for a change. When we say there is a demographic dividend and we are the world's youngest country, we tend to be too optimistic about it. Let's talk about the downsides as well.

**Santosh Lad (SL):** Opportunities are important and they play a vital role. There is competition in every field today. You need to fight for your place. As for success, it has become a question of only balance-sheets. Especially for the media, which features only celebrities. The only thing that this country is motivated by now is commerce. For example, look at the hype around Varun Gandhi. The media is not playing the